

The Wedding-Day *Timeline.*

A calm, camera-ready plan for the best day of your life — built from three hundred and fifty weddings.



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TONE MEDIA · NJ WEDDING FILMS

Twelve years. 350 weddings.

Still crying at the readings.

Seven things that quietly *wreck* a wedding-day timeline.

We've watched all seven happen from behind the camera. Every one is avoidable — and fixing them is the difference between a bride who's rushing and a bride who's present.

1 Hair & makeup always runs long.

It's the first domino, and when it tips, the whole day slides. **Ask your glam team for their exact timeline, then add 30 minutes on top of it.** Being ready early is a gift — it's when the calmest, prettiest getting-ready footage happens.

2 You forgot to count the drive.

Prep to ceremony, ceremony to portraits, portraits to venue — every leg eats real time. **Write each drive on the timeline as its own line, with the address.** A single unplanned hour-long drive can quietly swallow your entire portrait window.

3 No buffer means you feel rushed — and it shows.

The camera reads tension. **Build a 10–15 minute cushion after every major block.** Those unhurried in-between moments — a quiet look, a laugh with your dad — are almost always the ones that end up in the film.

4 You haven't decided on a first look.

It's the single biggest lever on your whole day. **A first look moves portraits earlier and hands you your cocktail hour back.** Skip it for the aisle reveal — just know you'll spend cocktail hour taking photos instead of hugging your friends. Neither is wrong. Decide on purpose.

5 Golden hour is fifteen minutes, and you'll be mid-reception.

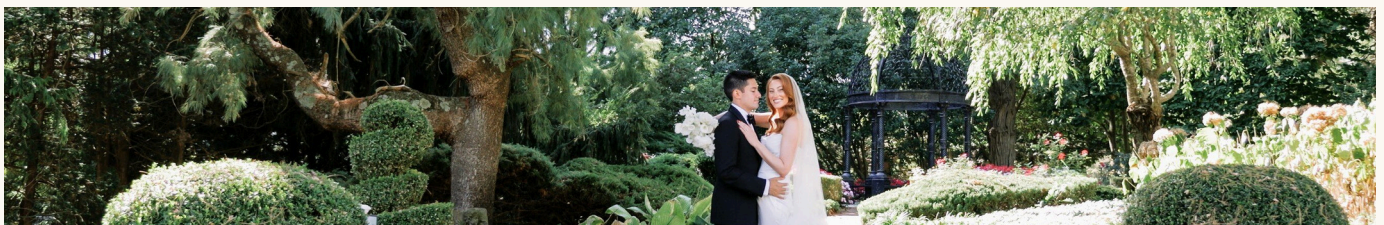
Ask your planner what time the sun sets, and steal ten minutes to step outside. It is the best-looking light of the entire day, every single time. Your future self will thank you for those frames.

6 Family photos are where time goes to die.

Grandma wandered off, no one knows the list, twenty minutes vanish. **Make a shot list, cap it around 8–10 groupings, and hand one loud, organized aunt the job of calling names.** (There's a shot list on the last page.)

7 You won't eat — unless you schedule it.

Ask your caterer to plate the two of you first, and protect fifteen minutes to actually sit down. A couple who ate is a couple who enjoyed their own reception. It matters more than you'd think.



UNHURRIED IS A LOOK. IT READS ON CAMERA.

TONE MEDIA · NEW JERSEY

A day that *flows*.

A realistic sample built from how we run a full luxury wedding day. Times are a starting point — slide them to fit your ceremony and sunset, and keep the durations honest.

Getting ready 2.5 HRS · BRIDE

- 10:00 am Details out & ready to film — dress, rings, invitation suite, shoes, heirlooms. Hair & makeup candids begin.
- 11:15 am Into the dress. Robes, first-look-with-the-girls, a moment with mom.
- 11:45 am Private letter exchange (read off-camera — we capture your faces, not the words).

FILM NOTE

Lay your details out the night before in one box. Ten minutes now saves a frantic hunt for the rings later.

First look & ceremony OPTIONAL LOOK · 30–60 MIN MASS

- 12:30 pm First look (optional) + couple portraits while the light is soft.
- 2:00 pm Ceremony. Plan a full mass at 60 min, a shorter service at 25–30.
- 3:00 pm Exit — bells, petals, or a quiet walk back up the aisle together.

Portraits FAMILY + COUPLE · ~90 MIN

- 3:10 pm Family & wedding-party portraits (run the shot list — this is the block that runs late).
- 4:00 pm Couple portraits + any travel to the reception venue.

FILM NOTE

If you skipped the first look, this is now competing with your cocktail hour. Front-load the family groupings so you don't miss your own party.

Cocktail hour & sunset 60–90 MIN

- 6:00 pm Cocktail hour. We film the room & details before guests pour in — signature drink, tablescape, the little touches.
- 7:00 pm Ballroom reveal, then **steal 10 minutes for golden hour**.

Reception ~4 HRS

- 7:30 pm Grand intros → first dance → parent dances, straight into an open set.
- 8:15 pm Welcome toast & dinner. **Eat now — you first.** Speeches over dinner.
- 9:15 pm Cake, then the party opens up — bouquet toss, the fun stuff.
- 11:00 pm Last dance & sparkler exit. Save something in the tank for it — the exit is a finale, not an afterthought.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

Build *your* day.

Fill this in, then send it to your planner, photographer, videographer and DJ. One shared timeline is the secret every calm wedding has in common.

Your timeline

START TIME → END TIME

Getting ready	start · location
First look	yes / no · time
Ceremony	time · address
Portraits	family + couple
Travel	how long, really?
Cocktail	sunset at _____
Reception	intros → last dance
Exit	sparklers? time?

Vendor & socials

SO EVERYONE GETS TAGGED & STAYS IN SYNC

PLANNER	_____
PHOTOGRAPHER	_____
VIDEOGRAPHER	@tonemedia
FLORALS	_____
DJ / BAND	_____
GLAM	_____

Family shot list

CHECK THE ONES YOU WANT · KEEP IT TO ~10

- ☐ Couple + bride's parents
- ☐ Couple + groom's parents
- ☐ Couple + both sets of parents
- ☐ Couple + grandparents
- ☐ Couple + siblings
- ☐ Bride + her whole family
- ☐ Groom + his whole family
- ☐ Full wedding party
- ☐ Bride + bridesmaids
- ☐ Groom + groomsmen
- ☐ Anyone who travelled far / VIPs
- ☐ The one grouping you'll regret missing

Don't-forget details

HAVE THESE READY TO FILM FIRST THING

- ☐ Rings · invitation suite · vows
- ☐ Dress, shoes & something borrowed
- ☐ Heirloom / letter / a private gift
- ☐ Anyone *not* to film (yes, really)



WHEN YOU'RE READY

Want this day *on film*?

We're Justin & Stephanie — Tone Media, New Jersey. 350 weddings, and we still cry at the readings.

tonemediastudio.com

START AT TONE.DAD

5.0 · 38 REVIEWS · THE KNOT